	Nursing action	Rationale
11	Ensure that safety precautions are followed	
12	Wash hands	
13	Document time, flow rate and observations made on patient.	
14	Encourage patient to breath through his/her nose with mouth closed	Provides for optimal delivery of oxygen to patient.
15	Remove and clean the cannula with soap and water, dry and replace every 8 hours. Assess nares at least every 8 hours.	Presence of cannula causes irritation and dryness of the mucous membrane.

Special Precautions

1. Never deliver more than 2-3 liters of oxygen to patients with chronic lung disease, e.g. COPD (chronic obstructive pulmonary disease)
2. Check frequently that both prongs are in patient's nares.

Oxygen concentration will vary on many factors like patient's tidal volume and ventilator pattern.

Oxygen concentration with flow rates

Flow rate	Oxygen concentration
1 Litre	24 to 25%
2 Litres	27 to 29%
3 Litres	30 to 33%
4 Litres	33 to 37%
5 Litres	36 to 41%
6 Litres	39 to 45%

2.3.2 Administering Oxygen by Mask Method

Definition

Administering oxygen to the patient by means of a mask (simple / venturi) according to requirement of patient.

Purpose

1. To relieve dysponea.
2. To administer higher concentration of oxygen.

Articles

1. Oxygen source
2. Mask (simple / or with venture adaptor high flow device of appropriate size)
3. Humidifier with distilled water
4. Flow meter
5. Gauze pieces
6. "No Smoking" sign.

Practical 2.indd 270 07/05/18 2:20 PM